Arc'teryx × BYU Fashion Association Case Competition

Kai Rinne · Caleb Wilde · Mackay Larsen · Sutton Spotts

Team 11

Situation: Arc'teryx Sustainability Efforts

Arc'teryx

Founded 1989 in North Vancouver, Headquartered on the unceded territories of the xʷməθkʷəy̓əm, Skwxwú7mesh, and səlilwətaɬ Peoples — land acknowledgment and innovation is core to brand identity.

ReBird

Arc'teryx's circular program launched 2021 with four pillars: Wash, Repair, Resale, Trade-In service centers worldwide. Represents Arc'teryx's organization-wide commitment to shift away from a take-make-waste economy

Sustainability

Arc'teryx treats sustainability as a design challenge, — 65% of a garment's environmental impact happens before it ever reaches a store. Guided by science-based targets and circularity principles, their answer is ReBIRD: every repair, resale, and trade-in shifts the system.

Complication: Scaling Circularity and Sustainability

Too low intake volume

28K

garments repaired in 2024

vs. Patagonia's 50K annual and TNF's 200K+ lbs diverted from landfills since 2018

80+

stores carry ReBIRD

yet consumer awareness and intake volume remain critically low

Used Gear feels Used

"People love the story behind the piece of gear — products sell much faster when they have an obvious fix that tells that story."

— Dominique Showers, VP ReBIRD, Arc'teryx

Views on circular Fashion

"Over half our ReBIRD customers are younger and new to the brand. Now we need to help others shift their buying behaviors too."

— Katie Wilson, Senior Manager Sustainability, Arc'teryx

Project Adventure Never Ends

01

ReBIRD TRACEABILITY

- Every ReBIRD product receives a cycle count number stitched beneath the Arc'teryx logo.
- A permanent marker of where this product stands in the entire history of the circular system.
- Gives products adventure history on ReBIRD website and gives it a story.

$750,000

02

ReBIRD NESTS

- Global pop-up tour hitting outdoor events and university campuses
- Each "Nest" includes ReBird Retail rack, ReCare demo, and information kiosk for ReBird Tracibility and Cycle One.
- Coincides with launch of "Cycle One" and release of ReBird product tracability

$750,000

03

ReBIRD CYCLE ONE

- Elite Arc'teryx athletes document extreme adventures in each of the first 50 tracible products (#1-50)
- Limited drop of those first 50 numbered items which are visibly patched, repaired, ReBIRD products
- After 3 month initiative pushing engagement, released free to the public through a global lottery
- Lottery tickets are received by engaging with circularity of ReBird

$2 Million

Total: $3.5M – $6M

ReBird Gear Passport: Turning Used Gear into Adventure Artifacts

Problem

Arc'tery created ReBird to extend product life through repair and resale. However, refurbished products are often perceived simply as “Used gear”, reducing emotional connection and limiting resale demand.

Solution

Turn each refurbished item into a traceable artifact. Each ReBird product receives a serialized identity, digital history, and passport-style tag highlighting its adventures and sustainability impact.

How it works

Adventure Submission at Trade in

Customers returning gear answer three short prompts

- Coolest place the article has been
- Most memorable adventures
- Toughest conditions it survived

Digital Product Passport

Customers can enter the serial number online to view

- Adventure history
- Ownership lifecycle
- Sustainability impact

Gear Passport Tag

Refurbished items are sold with a small passport-style tag displaying

- Adventure history
- Sustainability Impact

ReBird Gear Passport: Validating the Idea with Research

Addressing Possible Concerns: consumer interest, engagement, and operational cost

CONSUMER INTREST

Concern
Customers may not care about the story or history of the jacket.

Research Evidence
-> Transparency about a product's lifecycle increases trust and willingness to purchase refurbished products in secondhand marketplaces.
-> Narrative descriptions explaining the history of a product increase perceived authenticity and persuasiveness in resale listings.

Implication
Adventure history becomes a trust signal, reducing uncertainty and increasing purchase confidence in refurbished gear.

ENGAGEMENT

Concern
Customers may not interact with the digital passport.

Research Evidence
->60% of shoppers say they see value in scanning QR codes on apparel to access product information.
->71% of consumers say transparency about product origin and lifecycle information is important when purchasing clothing.

Implication
Consumers increasingly expect traceability and transparency when evaluating second hand apparel products.

Operational Feasibility

Concern
Traceability systems may increase operational complexity.

Research Evidence
->Bain & Company reports that digital product passports can **double fashion product lifetime value** by improving authentication, resale confidence, repair visibility, and post-sale transparency.

Implication
For ReBird, traceability is not just an operational burden. It is a revenue and trust infrastructure that can increase resale value, support Arc'teryx-owned circular commerce, and make refurbished gear more credible than generic secondhand listings.

Sources: ScienceDirect Consumer Trust in Secondhand Markets Study; Avery Dennison Digital Consumer Behavior Report, Bain & Company Digital Product

ReBird Pop-up Nests: Universities and Outdoor Events

Key Initiatives

- Leverage the design DNA of Arc'teryx's existing mobile infrastructure and transition from heavy static infrastructure to modular, highly velocity "Nest" kits to increase geographic reach and reduce logistical carbon impact
- Deploy the 10 ReBird "Nest" Kits across 40 Universities over a 4-week window to capture a priced out demographic and spread ReBird initiative and brand awareness to the next generation of users.
- Utilize and deploy the ReBird "Nest" Kits to global outdoor sport events and festivals, focused on events where Arc'teryx gear will be used (Rock climbing events, Back country Skiing festivals, Mountain biking events)

Sources: Lindenwood.edu Sports Sponsorship Research; EcoEagle Campus Campaign thesis, USM; Springer Nature Circular Economy & Sustainability

Limited Edition and Storytelling Multiply Engagement

What Is Key In Successful Limited Edition Drops?

Collaborations → Collaboration with Athletes

Storytelling → Elite athletes create story for each product

Uniqueness → Cycle count number and unique repaired products

Arc'teryx has done and succeeded in both limited-edition items and giveaways before

15% Sales — Giveaways and contests can increase sales by 15%

4x ROI — Giveaways have been shown to return upwards of 4x ROI

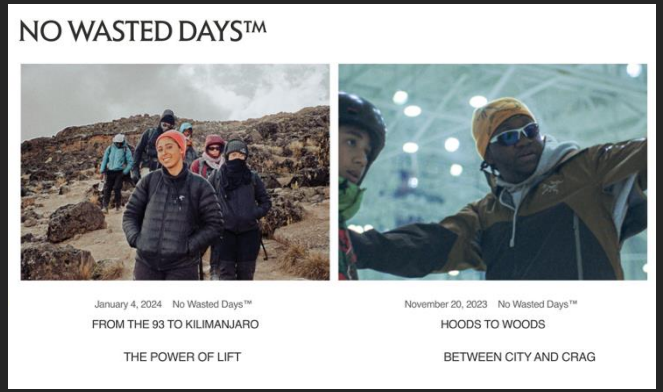
60% — 60% of Consumers buy based on fear of missing out

Athletes x Arc'teryx is feasible and will drive engagement

- Arc'teryx already has a team of athletes and ambassadors

Arc'teryx. "Athletes & Ambassadors." *Arc'teryx*, arcteryx.com/us/en/athletes.

- Arcteryx own athlete-film campaign "No Wasted Days" for ReGear in 2024 was a success
  - **127%** YoY growth in ReGear engagement
  - **80%** increase in Arcteryx academy attendance



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The Impact

+25–50%

ReBIRD intake volume

Target: 35-42K+ garments in Year 1 vs 28K baseline

50K+

Cycle One lottery entries

Global reach across 6+ continents; 100K+ social impressions

+60-80%

Lift among Gen Z in activated markets

40 campuses + outdoor events; 2,000–4,500 direct signups

6 – 50M

Social Media Impressions

50-athlete Atlas Drop, using OpenSponsorship athlete engagement benchmarks

$1.2M

Resale Value from ReBird Alone in Year 1

Trade in Estimates converted to Resale

Year 2

self-sustaining flywheel

Cycle Two launches at <30% of Year 1 cost; infrastructure already built

Thank You.

Kai Rinne · Caleb Wilde · Mackay Larsen · Sutton Spotts · Team #11

"Leave It Better."

Arc'teryx x BYU Fashion Association Case Competition March 6, 2026

Appendix

Supporting Data, Sources & Full Budget

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B. Cost Calculation

ReBird "Nest" Kits

Expense Category	Benchmarked Rate	Calculation for 10 Units / 40 Stops	Subtotal
Modular Kit Fabrication (CapEx)	$25,000 / unit	Includes structural "Monolith," recycled fabric tension walls, 2x industrial heat presses ($3K/ea), 2x iPad Pro kiosks, and rolling gear racks.	$250,000
Fleet Lease & Logistics	$2,000 / week / unit	Lease of 10 high-roof transit vans (e.g., Ford Transit) + fuel and insurance for a 4-week active tour plus 1-week prep.	$100,000
Human Capital (Labor)	$3,500 / week / team	20 Brand Ambassadors (2 per unit). Includes base pay plus $150/day per diem for travel and lodging.	$280,000
Venue Activation Fees	$2,000 / stop	Average "Sponsorship/Vendor" fee for a 2-day footprint at premier campuses (e.g., CU Boulder or UBC) and local event permits.	$80,000
Inventory & Fulfillment	$1,000 / stop	Shipping resale inventory to local hubs and returning trade-ins to ARC'ONE for processing.	$40,000
TOTAL OPEX + CAPEX			$750,000

Product Traceability

Cost Item	Cost
Backend platform development	$200,000
Consumer-facing web/mobile app	$80,000
NFC tags (100K units @ $0.80)	$80,000
API integration with ReBird inventory	$60,000
Year 1 hosting & maintenance	$60,000
Launch marketing (signage, hang tags, content)	$85,000
Tag integration + staff training	$45,000
UI/UX design	$50,000
QA & security audit	$40,000
Contingency (10%)	$50,000
TOTAL	**$750,000**

B. Cost Calculation (Cycle One)

Item	Estimate
Athlete hero films (~10 pieces)	$400–600K
Supporting athlete content (~40 pieces)	$300–500K
Garment prep + custom stitching (50 items)	$50–100K
Lottery platform build + global infrastructure	$150–200K
Closing video production	$100–150K
Global winner fulfillment + shipping	$50–100K
PR + media seeding	$300–400K
Total Initiative 3	**$1.35–2.05M**

Item	Low	High	Basis for Estimate
Athlete hero films (~10 pieces)	$400K	$600K	$40–60K per film — industry standard for boutique outdoor film production; consistent with Arc'teryx's existing Boldly partnership on No Wasted Days
Supporting athlete content (~40 pieces)	$300K	$500K	$7.5–12.5K per piece — short-form athlete POV content, minimal crew, location-based shooting; athletes already on contract
Garment prep + custom stitching (50 items)	$50K	$100K	$1–2K per item for sourcing, repair work, contrasting patch application, and cycle number stitching at ARC'ONE
Lottery platform build + global infrastructure	$150K	$200K	Custom web build with tiered entry logic, global compliance, and winner selection — comparable to mid-tier contest platform builds
Closing video production	$100K	$150K	Single cinematic piece, Arc'teryx internal creative team or existing production partner — lower cost than hero films given no athlete travel
Global winner fulfillment + shipping	$50K	$100K	50 items shipped internationally — premium packaging, tracking, customs handling at ~$1–2K per winner
PR + media seeding	$300K	$400K	Outdoor and lifestyle media outreach, press kit production, targeted digital seeding across Arc'teryx's core markets
Total	**$1.35M**	**$2.05M**	**Saving ~$1.5–2M vs. Red Bull version — brings overall strategy to ~$5.1–7.25M, within $5–10M constraint**

REBIRD
PASSPORT
Serial #: RB-00001
Adventures:
Backcountry Skiing – Whistler
Wildfire Research Trip – Sierra Nevada
Alpinism – Kamchatka
Carbon Saved:
~ 34 kg CO_2
rebird.arcteryx.com
RB-00001
ARC'TERYX

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RB-0000
ARC'TERY

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SAVE THE PLANET. REBIRTH THE GEAR.
ARC'TERYX
REBIRD
THE CYCLE
REBIRD 2.0: TRACE THE JOURNEY.
DROP ITEM #1:
FOUNDING
Cycle Count
#001
DIGITAL PASSPORT POSTAL
PREOWNED PERFORMANCE
PREOWNED PERFORMANCE

SAVE THE PLANET.
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REBIRD
THE CYCLE
REBIRD 2.0: TRACE THE JOURNEY.
WASH, REPAIR, TRADE-IN, RESALE.
DROP ITEM #1:
FOUNDING
Artifact
REBIRD RESALE:
STORIED GEAR
#001
PREOWNED
PERFORMANCE
DIGITAL
PASSPORT
PORTAL
Cycle Count
#001
PREOWNED
PERFORMANCE
ARC'TERYX
REBIRD